be worked out by the core group that should accord priority to the tenets of counterterrorism elaborated in Part IV earlier. As a result, there has been greater effectiveness in the law enforcement, and the overall situation is better, though not yet as peaceful as is desirable.

Keeping in mind the security challenges faced by the state, I was convinced that there was a need for raising 'Arunachal Scouts', a force on the lines of Ladakh Scouts, to act as a force multiplier for the army for the defence of Arunachal Pradesh. Accordingly, a proposal was forwarded to the government in 2008. Chief Minister Dorjee Khandu and I lost no opportunity to impress upon the decision-makers in Delhi the need to sanction this proposal at an early date. On 22 January 2009, I wrote to Defence Minister A.K. Antony:

> It is beyond any doubt that the establishment of Arunachal Scouts is of the greatest importance for strategic and other reasons. Further, when we start recruiting the local youths we are ensuring productive employment to a large number of youngsters in Arunachal Pradesh who otherwise may be misled by anti-social elements. The youth selected for Arunachal Scouts would be force multipliers wherever we face a challenge to our security. They would get an opportunity to defend their homeland, act as guides and interpreters, would not require much acclimatization in the high altitudes and would know how to live off the land. It may be recalled that during the Kargil War, the Ladakh Scouts played a vital role in the eviction of the Pakistani intruders, and facilitated the operations of the army tremendously.

The idea of Arunachal Scouts had taken strong roots by then. After almost two years of pushing the project to make it a reality, it was a source of great satisfaction to see that the first battalion of this force has been raised at Shillong. Both the chief minister and I joined in the raising day ceremonies during November 2010. I congratulated the officers and men and complimented them for their high morale and esprit de corps. After my address to all ranks of 1st Arunachal Scouts, I presented a silver trophy to the battalion. Eventually, Arunachal Scouts is likely to comprise four battalions and a training centre. During a visit to Itanagar, the defence